



Digital Literacy Awareness Project (CSE0001)

PROJECT REPORT

Name: Rishav Raj

Registration Number: 25BCE11039

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Introduction

The Digital Literacy Awareness Project (CSE0001) is more than just a technological imperative; it is a road map for navigating the complexities of our professional and academic worlds. In a world where being "online" is a perpetual state of being, simply being familiar with a device is no longer sufficient. This project was created to bridge the gap between being familiar with a device and being intentional with digital engagement.

In my role as a Student Digital Ambassador, I have successfully completed five digital tasks that simulate real-world scenarios. Along the way, I have become familiar with the art of visual communication, created a professional digital footprint, and enhanced my digital literacy skills. I have become familiar with the complexities of professional email etiquette and have examined the harsh realities of today's cyber world. This is more than just a series of assignments; it is a way of creating a digital presence with a sense of purpose and responsibility.

Task 1:

What I made: I designed an infographic titled "A Student's Guide to Digital Literacy" that would educate fellow students about digital literacy on a single page. My infographic consists of three different sections, including defining digital literacy, "Safe Internet Practices" (password managers, two-factor authentication, avoiding public Wi-Fi, etc.), and having a "Professional Online Presence." I especially emphasized the need to have a "Code & Connect" strategy, where it is recommended to keep your Python or Java code on GitHub while keeping your LinkedIn profile clean.

Tool used: I chose Canva, which is a great tool for creating infographics due to its user-friendly interface. This allowed me to add an interesting digital tree background, which is often associated with technology, while keeping the text boxes organized, thereby making the content more readable.

Reflection: Looking back at this assignment, I understand just how difficult it is to take complex information and make it concise, yet visually engaging and consumable. This assignment has also helped me understand that digital communication is not just what you say, but how you make it easily consumable by the reader. This infographic has also helped reinforce my knowledge of digital safety and the image I am creating as a CSE student.

Task 2:

Which ones I chose: To build my professional digital footprint as a CSE student, I chose to build and optimize profiles on four major platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, HackerRank, and Kaggle.

What each one is used for: GitHub is a version control platform for hosting and sharing code repositories. It is used to demonstrate my coding abilities through hackathon projects like "MediConnect" and "Virasat-Setu." LinkedIn is a professional networking tool for connecting with industry peers and showcasing my academic progress. HackerRank is a competitive coding platform for testing and improving my coding abilities in languages like Python and Java. Finally, Kaggle is a data science platform for exploring and working with datasets and machine learning models.

How I plan to utilize them in the next four years: Over the next four years in B.Tech, I plan to utilize these profiles as a dynamic resume. Currently, since my last two hackathons are over, my immediate plan for GitHub is to optimize my existing code. However, in the future, I plan to continue to add coursework and projects. For HackerRank, I plan to utilize it to prepare for placements, Kaggle to build a data science portfolio, and LinkedIn to share all these accomplishments, essentially "networking my way" to summer internships.

Task 3

What platform(s) I used: To satisfy the requirements of both the coding practice and the cloud collaboration, I have used two different platforms. One platform used for the coding practice is HackerRank. Another platform used for the cloud collaboration is Google Workspace, specifically Google Forms and Google Sheets.

What I built or practised: As part of the HackerRank platform, I have actively practiced my programming logic skills through a series of beginner-level challenges, which ultimately led to my achievement of the Python Basic certification. As part of the cloud collaboration, I have created a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" comprising a total of 5 questions using Google Forms. This quiz comprises a series of multiple-choice and short answer questions aimed at my batchmates on the topic of safe internet practices. In addition to this, I have linked this Google Form with a Google Sheet.

How these tools will help me academically: As a CSE student, I find both tools to be very useful for my academic growth. First and foremost, HackerRank is a platform where I have actively practiced my programming logic skills, and this would be very useful for my future technical placements. In addition to this, Google Workspace would be very useful for my academic growth, specifically for coordinating my projects with my batchmates and for conducting surveys for my research assignments.

Task 4

Situation where poor communication caused a problem: A student contacted a startup founder on LinkedIn to apply for an internship but used SMS language and slang like "Hey, u guys hiring? i code in py." The founder was looking for a professional student to assist with client data and immediately declined the application. The student had an amazing GitHub profile, but due to poor digital communication skills, it was evident that they were immature and not yet ready to be in a professional environment.

What could have been done differently: The student could have easily got the interview by adopting a professional tone. The student should have introduced themselves as a B.Tech student and mentioned their specific projects, and requested a formal way to submit their resume. This is basic etiquette, and the student is showing respect for the person's time and professionalism.

Task 5

What surprised you most: As I researched the Ransomware attack on AIIMS Delhi in the year 2022, I was most surprised by how a particular vulnerability in the digital world could completely paralyze a massive and critical institution. It was a surprise to see how a premier national-level hospital was forced to go back to manual record-keeping using paper and pen for a matter of weeks. It was eye-opening to see how cyber threats are not just about losing money or data but how they could physically hamper life-saving services and threaten the lives of millions of patients. It was a surprise to see how, despite having the best of security measures in place, the human factor or a server could pose a great risk.

One habit you will personally change: As a result of this research, I have committed myself to the following personal habit: As a CSE student, it is very easy to overlook update notifications on my devices, but I have now committed myself to not doing so. I have understood how essential it is to update my devices with the latest patches to avoid vulnerabilities. In addition to this, I have committed myself to not downloading any unverified software or cracked versions of any program.

Conclusion:

This project has been an eye-opener for me as I am beginning my B.Tech journey. Going beyond the simple concept of using an app, I have learned how to utilize platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn to aid in my future internship search. Writing professional emails and learning about the AIIMS cyber attack have also taught me that it is not enough to be tech-

savvy; one also needs to be responsible and aware of their surroundings. I feel much more confident in the digital space not just as a student but also as an upcoming engineer.

References:

- Canva: <https://www.canva.com/> , for making the task 1 presentation
- HackerRank: <https://www.hackerrank.com/> , for task 3 certification and coding
- Google Forms: <https://forms.gle/Bu2HESfgeXrQUxvN7> , task 3 google form link
- CERT-In: [India Ransomware Report 2022]
https://www.csk.gov.in/documents/RANSOMWARE_Report_Final.pdf
- The Economic Times (2022): [AIIMS ransomware attack: what it means for health data privacy] <https://ciso.economictimes.indiatimes.com/news/aiims-ransomware-attack-what-it-means-for-health-data-privacy/96538957>